

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

We take a look at some of the strangest F1 cars we've seen over the course of time and look into Hustle porn and other kinds of porn (don't get turned off by the word 'porn', you should know about this).



Trails of wind

The global wind patterns affects our archeology, and this is most apparent in the orientations of airport runways across the world. These invisible forces that shape human civilisation on a large scale can only be seen through visualisations. <https://dgit.in/windtrails>

WHAT'S NEW

Commuting principle that shaped cities

The growth of cities follows a principle that has remained more or less constant throughout history. The average length for a daily commute is about half an hour. While there are cities with longer average daily commute times, this principle has guided how large a city grows all the way from ancient Rome to sprawling modern metropolises such as Atlanta. The cut off point for the growth is roughly the time it takes to reach the heart of the settlement. Beyond the point of about half an hour, the value of the land starts falling sharply. Cities have grown exponentially keeping step with the advancements in transportation technologies. Walking, street cars, underground railways, and expressways have evolved over time,



allowing cities to grow larger. But now, we are facing some challenges. The only real option to packing in more people, is vertical growth, but that comes at a heavy environmental cost. Because of over-crowding, the existing

infrastructure is being increasingly taxed. The channels of transport are getting crowded, slowing down the commute for everyone. Another option is to split the work from the location, known as telecommuting. <https://dgit.in/cityftr>

Citizens should be allowed to kick robots

Assaults on security robots in the US have called into focus the ethics of how humans treat robots. The robot in question, is an autonomous security robot called K5, that patrols the streets, records videos and identifies number plates. The very presence of the robot makes people nervous. According to the argument, people should be allowed to assault or otherwise damage robots, because a blanket ban has never really proven effective.



According to the author, similar questions wouldn't be asked if vandals destroyed security cameras. Why are humans expected to have more empathy towards moving pieces of autonomous machinery? The security robot

represents a real threat to humans, because it is manufactured by a private company, which can collect people's data and store it. The whole idea of the robot is to make people police themselves. The call to action, is to damage these robots because they are unfeeling pieces of machinery, cannot feel pain, and cannot really understand the emotions or needs of the people that they are watching over.

<https://dgit.in/ratm>



Mail a package from Space

Delivering a package from the ISS is surprisingly easy, all you need to do is lob it and eventually it will reach Earth. Astronauts on space walks have done this by mistake with wrenches and cameras. The difficult bit is to make sure that the item does not get burned up in the atmosphere. <https://dgit.in/spacemail>



Unix at 50

Unix variants power both iOS and Android devices around the world. The operating system just turned 50 years old, and although it has taken over the world, it started its life as a failure. In fact, the project was abandoned at one point, after the developers claimed they had achieved everything they wanted to with it. <https://dgit.in/unix50>



Free will exists

A spike in neurological activity before taking an action indicates that human brains work even before they're aware of their actions. The finding was used as an argument against the existence of free will, but a new study suggests that we may have been reading the data all along, and might have made a classic mistake. <https://dgit.in/freewill>